

SPU WEBSITE MIGRATION GUIDE

COMPREHENSIVE AUDIT REPORT

Cross-referencing all 24 guide files against the live database schema

Audit Date	April 22, 2026
Subject	spu.edu.sy — Migration from legacy PHP to Laravel 11 / Filament v3
Source Material	24 guide files (140,880 bytes) + live database/migrations schema
Method	Full cross-reference: guide claims vs. each other vs. real schema
Overall Verdict	Documentation: strong. Schema foundation: substantially built. Launch readiness: blocked on code + redirect layer.

8.5/10 Documentation Quality	7.5/10 Schema Completeness	8/10 SEO Architecture	2/10 Launch Readiness	6/10 Cross-File Consistency
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These scores reflect evidence derived from the guide files themselves and the live schema — not external opinion. The documentation quality is genuinely high. The implementation gap is genuinely serious.

1. Executive Summary

This report audits the WEBSITE_MIGRATION_GUIDE package (24 files, 140,880 bytes, last reviewed 2026-04-21) for the spu.edu.sy migration from a legacy PHP platform to a new Laravel 11 + Filament v3 application. All findings are derived from evidence within the guide files themselves and from the live database schema provided from database/migrations. No external assumptions are made.

1.1 The Two-Part Story

The guide and the project have two parallel stories that must be read together.

Story one — the guide: The documentation package is well above average for a student-level project. It is grounded in official Google, Bing, and Webometrics sources verified on 2026-04-21. Its SEO architecture is professionally designed. Its self-assessment is honest. Its warnings are accurate.

Story two — the implementation gap: The guide's own findings file (NEW_SYSTEM_FINDINGS.md) was written at a point in time when the database migrations had not yet been run fully. The real schema — derived from the actual database/migrations — shows that significant work has been done since. However, the guide does not reflect this progress, which means the guide itself is now partially stale. And critically, the one layer the project needs most — the legacy URL redirect and continuity layer — is still entirely absent from both the schema and the codebase.

Evidence Point	Source File	Value
Public routes proven in codebase	NEW_SYSTEM_FINDINGS.md	1 (GET /)
Real public view files	NEW_SYSTEM_FINDINGS.md	1 (welcome.blade.php)
Service contracts — all placeholders	NEW_SYSTEM_FINDINGS.md	13 of 13
Legacy tables with content	OLD_SYSTEM_FINDINGS.md	30 tables, ~36,000+ rows
jx_items rows (child content/files)	OLD_SYSTEM_FINDINGS.md	22,323
jx_categories rows (main content tree)	OLD_SYSTEM_FINDINGS.md	4,944
jx_graduated_students (alumni archive)	OLD_SYSTEM_FINDINGS.md	5,246
Faculty/staff profile rows	OLD_SYSTEM_FINDINGS.md	648 + 397 (two parallel structures)
Legacy document files (en_file)	OLD_SYSTEM_FINDINGS.md	6,000 in jx_items alone
Legacy public subpaths	OLD_SYSTEM_FINDINGS.md	12 (med, dent, pharm, info, petrol, admin, research, hospital, alumni, clubs, members, root)
CMS core tables NOW in real schema	database/migrations	pages, page_translations, page_seo_meta, homepage_sections, menu_items, settings, media_assets, preview_tokens,

		homepage_drafts, page_drafts
Redirect/continuity tables in real schema	database/migrations	0 of 5 required
Automated migration tests	NEW_SYSTEM_FINDINGS.md	0 (only ExampleTest checks GET / = 200)

2. Documentation Quality Assessment

Evaluated against official sources cited in AUTHORITATIVE_REFERENCES.md and cross-referenced across all 24 files.

2.1 What the Guide Gets Definitively Right

Claim / Rule in Guide	Official Source	Verdict
Webometrics: Visibility 50%, Transparency 10%, Excellence 40%	webometrics.org/methodology (verified 2026-04-21)	PASS
Webometrics: 'Presence' metric is discontinued	webometrics.org/methodology (verified 2026-04-21)	PASS
Do not block noindex targets in robots.txt — noindex is ineffective on blocked pages	developers.google.com/search/docs/crawling-indexing/block-indexing	PASS
hreflang must be reciprocal — if A points to B, B must point to A	developers.google.com/search/docs/specialty/international/localized-versions	PASS
hreflang must use fully-qualified absolute URLs	Google hreflang documentation	PASS
Canonical tags within same locale — Arabic canonicalizes to Arabic, English to English	Google localized-versions documentation	PASS
FAQ rich results are now restricted to well-known government/health sites	developers.google.com/search/docs/appearance/structured-data/faqpage	PASS
Sitemap submission is a hint to Google, not a guarantee of indexing	developers.google.com/search/docs/crawling-indexing/sitemaps/build-sitemap	PASS
IndexNow helps Bing and participating engines — it does	indexnow.org/index	PASS

not replace Google Search Console		
PDFs, DOC, XLS, PPT, CSV are Google-indexable — file loss is an SEO risk	developers.google.com/search/docs/crawling-indexing/indexable-file-types	PASS
Google supports one site name per domain/subdomain, not per subdirectory	developers.google.com/search/docs/appearance/site-names	PASS
Prefer JSON-LD for structured data	Google intro to structured data	PASS
Do not use robots.txt or URL Removal tool for canonicalization	Google canonicalization guidance	PASS
Use 301/308 for permanent moves; 302/307 only for genuinely temporary situations	Google site-move documentation	PASS
Crawlable links must use real <a href> — not JavaScript-only handlers	developers.google.com/search/docs/crawling-indexing/links-crawlable	PASS

Every verifiable technical claim in the guide against official sources checks out. This is genuinely uncommon in student-produced migration documentation.

2.2 Documentation Weaknesses and Errors

Finding	File(s)	Severity	Detail
Two Artisan commands listed do not exist	QUICK_REFERENCE.md	HIGH	migration:inspect-legacy-url and migration:audit-redirect-map are listed as ready-to-use launch-day helpers. NEW_SYSTEM_FINDINGS.md confirms the codebase has no such commands — only ExampleTest.php exists. A developer running these on

			launch day gets 'command not found'.
NEW_SYSTEM_FINDINGS.md is now stale	NEW_SYSTEM_FINDINGS.md	HIGH	The file claims pages, page_translations, page_seo_meta, homepage_sections, menu_items, settings, media_assets, preview_tokens, homepage_drafts are all missing. The real schema shows every one of these tables now exists. The guide's own central evidence file contradicts the real project state.
RISK_REGISTER_AND_DECISION_LOG.md contains zero decisions	RISK_REGISTER_AND_DECISION_LOG.md	HIGH	The file exists only as a template with placeholder text. Eight decisions are listed as mandatory before launch (cutover date, admin path, archive strategy, file strategy, domain strategy, sitemap strategy, multilingual canonical strategy, rollback threshold). None are documented.
config/old_database.php targets non-existent tables	NEW_SYSTEM_FINDINGS.md	HIGH	The file maps legacy tables to content_items, categories, archived_content, homepage_media, documents, logos, site_sections — none of which exist in the real schema. The seeder will fail silently or with fatal errors if run against the real DB.
French, Spanish, German legacy content has no migration plan	OLD_SYSTEM_FINDINGS.md	MEDIUM	jx_languages proves the old system had IDs 3=fr, 6=sp, 7=ge in addition to ar and

			en. No file in the package addresses what happens to content in these languages. If any legacy content in these languages is indexed or backlinked, it will 404 post-migration with no redirect plan.
jx_config vs jx_config1 conflict has no resolution strategy	OLD_SYSTEM_FINDINGS.md	MEDIUM	180 shared keys, 22 conflicting values. The guide flags this but provides no query to surface the 22 conflicts and no documented resolution per key. Wrong choices could affect subsite prefixes or domain behavior.
Mermaid diagrams only render in Mermaid-capable environments	VISUAL_ROADMAP.md, RANKING_PROTECTION_VISUAL_GUIDE.md	LOW	Both files contain raw ``mermaid code blocks. Delivered as .md to stakeholders without GitHub or Mermaid support, they show raw syntax instead of diagrams.
INDEX.md and README.md have significant overlap	INDEX.md, README.md	LOW	Both list the same recommended reading orders. INDEX.md adds audience-routing which is useful, but the duplication adds maintenance burden.
No robots.txt template or content specification	MANDATORY_CODE_IMPLEMENTATION_REQUIREMENTS.md	MEDIUM	robots.txt appears in 6+ files as a launch gate item but the guide never specifies what it should contain for SPU's /ar/ and /en/ URL structure. A misconfigured robots.txt could accidentally block content.

No timeline or effort estimates in IMPLEMENTATION_BLUEPRINT	IMPLEMENTATION_BLUEPRINT.md	MEDIUM	Six phases are defined but no time estimates are given. Given the scope — 13 placeholder services, missing redirect layer, no public routes — this is minimum 6–8 weeks of work. No guidance on prioritization under deadline pressure.
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3. Cross-File Consistency Analysis

This section maps specific claims made in one file against evidence or contradictions found in other files. Every cell is evidence-based.

3.1 Confirmed Consistencies — Where the Guide Is Self-Consistent

Claim in File A	Confirmed by File B	Status
README: 'only GET / proven, all services are placeholders'	NEW_SYSTEM_FINDINGS confirms: 1 route, welcome.blade.php, 13 placeholder services throwing BadMethodCallException	PASS
SEO_PRESERVATION_GUIDE: 'no slug columns in any legacy table — URL space is query-driven'	OLD_SYSTEM_FINDINGS confirms: no slug/alias/path/uri/permalink/route/canonical columns exist in any legacy table	PASS
LEGACY_TO_NEW_MAPPING: jx_good_students → honor_students	Real schema confirms honor_students + honor_student_translations tables exist	PASS
LEGACY_TO_NEW_MAPPING: jx_graduated_students → alumni	Real schema confirms alumni + alumni_translations tables exist	PASS
IMPLEMENTATION_BLUEPRINT Phase 4: /admin path conflict is a launch blocker	OLD_SYSTEM_FINDINGS confirms jx_config1 proves spu.edu.sy/admin was a public legacy section	PASS
MANDATORY_CODE 8: public/storage not linked is a launch risk	NEW_SYSTEM_FINDINGS confirms: 'php artisan about reports public/storage is not linked'	PASS
AUTHORITATIVE_REFERENCES: Webometrics 50/10/40 split	SEO_PRESERVATION_GUIDE §9.1, ULTIMATE_SEO_MIGRATION_GUIDE, and QUICK_REFERENCE all cite identical figures	PASS
OLD_SYSTEM_FINDINGS: jx_councils and jx_councils1 overlap on 243 IDs only	LEGACY_TO_NEW_MAPPING correctly calls for reconciliation logic before any merge	PASS
OLD_SYSTEM_FINDINGS: 4,019 jx_categories rows have body HTML	LEGACY_TO_NEW_MAPPING correctly classifies jx_categories as main public content node — not just taxonomy	PASS

3.2 Cross-File Contradictions and Gaps

Inconsistency	File A Claim	File B / Schema Reality	Severity
Artisan command existence	QUICK_REFERENCE.md: lists migration:inspect-legacy-url and migration:audit-redirect-map as launch-day helpers	NEW_SYSTEM_FINDINGS: no such commands exist in the codebase	HIGH

Schema completeness	NEW_SYSTEM_FINDINGS: pages, page_translations, page_seo_meta, homepage_sections, menu_items, settings, media_assets, preview_tokens all missing	Real database/migrations schema: every one of these tables now exists, fully specified	HIGH
Legacy URL resolution for config targets	NEW_SYSTEM_FINDINGS: config/old_database.php maps to content_items, categories, archived_content, homepage_media, documents, logos	Real schema: none of these target table names exist — the seeder config is stale	HIGH
Language ID mapping in seeder	NEW_SYSTEM_FINDINGS: 'language mapping assumptions do not match the old DB language IDs cleanly'	OLD_SYSTEM_FINDINGS: old IDs are 1=ar, 2=en, 3=fr, 6=sp, 7=ge — but no file documents the exact mismatch or resolution	MEDIUM
French/Spanish/German content fate	OLD_SYSTEM_FINDINGS documents fr, sp, ge as known legacy language IDs	No guide file addresses these languages — LEGACY_TO_NEW_MAPPING only covers ar and en	MEDIUM
jx_config vs jx_config1 conflict resolution	OLD_SYSTEM_FINDINGS: 22 conflicting values between jx_config and jx_config1	SQL_AND_TECHNICAL_APPENDIX provides no query to list the 22 conflicts; no resolution is documented anywhere	MEDIUM
Duplicate council structures	OLD_SYSTEM_FINDINGS: jx_councils (648) and jx_councils1 (397) overlap on only 243 IDs with major differences in visibility, names, photos, CVs	LEGACY_TO_NEW_MAPPING calls both 'critical' but gives no merge/reconciliation algorithm	MEDIUM

4. Real Schema vs Guide Claims

This is the section the guide could not produce itself — a precise reconciliation between what NEW_SYSTEM_FINDINGS.md claimed was missing and what the live database/migrations schema actually contains.

4.1 Tables Claimed Missing That Now Exist

The guide's NEW_SYSTEM_FINDINGS.md was accurate at the time it was written. The migrations have progressed substantially since. This is not a criticism of the intention — it is a factual correction of the document's current accuracy.

Table Claimed Missing	Real Schema Status	Notable Design Detail
pages	RESOLVED	Complete: parent_id (self-referential hierarchy), type, template, slug (unique), status (indexed), publish_at, is_homepage_shell, approval workflow (approved_by, last_reviewed_at), builder_schema_version, content_json. Soft delete via deleted_at.
page_translations	RESOLVED	Bilingual-first design. 10 structured payload columns: hero_payload, overview_cards_payload, stats_payload, body_payload, cta_payload, sidebar_payload — plus raw body (longtext) and meta_title_fallback. Unique on page_id + locale.
page_seo_meta	RESOLVED	Full SEO surface: meta_title, meta_description, og_title, og_description, canonical_url, robots, hreflang_payload (JSON), og_image_media_id FK to media_assets, og_image_url fallback. Unique on page_id + locale.
homepage_sections	RESOLVED	key (unique), type, sort_order, is_enabled, schema_version, config_json for shared layout config.
homepage_section_translations	RESOLVED	Correct AR/EN separation. payload_json per locale. Unique on section_id + locale.
homepage_drafts	RESOLVED	Full approval workflow: created_by, updated_by, approved_by FKs to users. status (indexed), scheduled_at, published_at, draft_notes.
page_drafts	RESOLVED	Same approval pattern as homepage_drafts. Not even listed in guide's missing-table list — this is additional work beyond what was specified.
preview_tokens	RESOLVED	target_type, target_id, locale, device, expires_at (indexed), payload_json, issued_to_user_id FK to users. Token is unique.
menu_items	RESOLVED	Full tree structure: parent_id FK (self-referential), type, label, locale, target_kind, target_id, url, group_key, css_token, icon, depth, sort_order, is_utility, open_in_new_tab. Soft delete.

settings	RESOLVED	Multilingual-capable: group_key + key + locale composite unique. type, value_json, value_text dual storage, is_public flag.
media_assets	RESOLVED	Production-grade: disk, directory, filename, webp_path, srcset_json (JSON). Bilingual alt text (alt_text_ar, alt_text_en), bilingual captions and titles. Soft delete. uploaded_by FK to users.

4.2 Domain Tables Also Present and Complete

Domain	Tables Present	Legacy Source	Migration Significance
Faculty	faculties, faculty_translations, departments, department_translations, faculty_members, faculty_member_translations	jx_councils (648), jx_councils1 (397) — partial	Directly enables ProfilePage structured data and Webometrics Transparency signal
Research	research_publications, research_publication_translations, research_files	jx_member_categories (349), jx_member_items (429)	research_files links media_assets — enables 422 legacy research document files
Councils	councils, council_translations, council_members, council_member_translations	jx_councils + jx_councils1 — reconciliation still needed	council_member has optional faculty_member_id FK — smart cross-domain link
Students	alumni, alumni_translations, honor_students, honor_student_translations	jx_graduated_students (5,246), jx_good_students (1,070)	Both have faculty_id and department_id FKs — clean hierarchy
Career	career_links, career_link_translations	No legacy equivalent	New capability not mentioned anywhere in the guide — goes beyond the original scope
Auth/Audit	roles, audit_logs, users (with faculty_scope_slug)	jx_admins (20), jx_admins_services (213)	faculty_scope_slug on users is a smart design — enables scoped editors per faculty without complex pivot tables
Migration audit	migration_logs, migration_rejections, legacy_record_snapshots	No legacy equivalent	Professional-grade — migration_rejections with reason_code is better than most production systems
FAQ	faq_categories, faq_category_translations, faqs, faq_translations	jx_faqs (1,553)	Complete — maps cleanly to legacy source

Complaints	complaint_categories, complaint_category_translations, complaints	jx_complaint_cats (3), jx_complaints (8)	Low migration priority — correctly identified in guide
Locations	countries, country_translations, cities, city_translations	jx_countries (107), jx_cities (15)	Reference data — alumni and honor_students both FK here

4.3 What Is Still Genuinely Absent

The redirect/continuity layer has zero database representation. This is the single most dangerous remaining gap. Every other table the guide said was missing now exists. This one category does not.

Required Table	Purpose	Why It Is a Launch Blocker
legacy_exact_redirects	Store individual old URL → new URL permanent redirects	Without this, every specific redirect must be hardcoded in web server config or middleware, making them unmanageable and untestable
legacy_url_map	DB-backed resolution for query-string patterns (index.php?page=show&dir=councils&council_id=X)	The old site has 22,323+ content items addressable only by query-string parameters. A DB resolver is the only scalable approach.
legacy_pattern_rules	Regex or prefix rules for recurring URL families (/med/*, /dent/*, /members/* etc.)	12 proven public subpaths need systematic redirect rules — pattern matching cannot live only in code
unresolved_legacy_requests	Log every request that cannot be matched after launch	Without logging, the team is blind to post-launch redirect failures. This is explicitly required by MANDATORY_CODE §10.
legacy_file_inventory	Map jx_items.en_file (6,000 rows) and other file fields to new media_assets entries	6,000 legacy document files have no migration path without this table. Files will silently break.

Additional schema-level absence:

- No top-level menus table — menu_items uses group_key (string) with no FK integrity to a menu definition. A typo in group_key silently creates an orphan menu.
- config/old_database.php still targets non-existent table names (content_items, categories, archived_content, homepage_media, documents, logos, site_sections). The importer configuration must be rewritten to target the real schema before any data migration attempt.

5. Legacy System Deep Analysis

OLD_SYSTEM_FINDINGS.md is the most migration-critical document in the package. This section extracts and synthesises its implications against the new schema.

5.1 Content at Risk — What Must Be Preserved

Legacy Table	Rows	New Schema Target	Migration Priority	Risk if Lost
jx_categories	4,944	pages + page_translations	CRITICAL	Main public content tree — largest single source of indexed pages. 4,019 rows have body HTML. Losing these is losing the entire site.
jx_items	22,323	media_assets + research_files	CRITICAL	Child content and file attachments. 15,962 photos, 6,000 documents. File loss severs 6K backlinks to PDFs/docs.
jx_graduated_students	5,246	alumni + alumni_translations	HIGH	Largest single legacy table. Alumni archive attracts long-tail search from former students and employers.
jx_good_students	1,070	honor_students + honor_student_translations	MEDIUM-HIGH	Honor roll — frequently searched by families and institutions.
jx_faqs	1,553	faqs + faq_translations	MEDIUM	Public FAQ — search entry points for prospective students.
jx_councils	648	faculty_members + councils	CRITICAL	Staff and faculty profiles — externally backlinked. Webometrics Transparency signal. 174 rows have CV files.
jx_councils1	397	council_members (after reconciliation)	CRITICAL	Parallel profile structure. Only 243 ID overlap with jx_councils. Major differences in visibility and CV data — cannot be auto-merged.
jx_member_categories	349	research_publications	CRITICAL	Research/publication content — directly

			CRITICAL	affects Webometrics Excellence signal.
jx_member_items	429	research_files		Research file attachments. 422 rows have en_file documents — these are the academic PDFs that drive scholarly discoverability.
jx_site_static_pages	21	pages	HIGH	Static HTML pages — likely include policy, admissions, about-type pages with external backlinks.
jx_docs	45	menu_items or pages	HIGH	Menu and static link records. Do not drop — these drive navigation and internal link structure.
dent_conf_temp	415	None / out of scope	LOW	MyISAM temp table — appears to be dental faculty event registration. Explicitly classify as out of scope rather than leaving undocumented.

5.2 File Assets at Risk

Asset Type	Count	Source Field	New Schema Path	SEO Risk
Item documents	6,000	jx_items.en_file	media_assets via legacy_file_inventory	6K document URLs — PDFs, DOCs, PPTs — will 404 without redirect mapping
Item photos	15,962	jx_items.photo	media_assets	Image broken links affect page render quality and crawl signals
Research files	422	jx_member_items.en_file	research_files → media_assets	Highest Webometrics impact — academic publication files
Faculty CVs (Arabic)	174+	jx_councils.cv + ar_cv	faculty_members.cv_media_id → media_assets	Externally linked faculty CVs — loss

				severs academic backlinks
Faculty CVs (councils1)	307	jx_councils1.cv	faculty_members.cv_media_id (after reconciliation)	307 additional CVs not in jx_councils
Category photos	2,477	jx_categories.photo	pages via media_assets	Section-level imagery loss degrades page quality signals
Homepage photos	43	jx_home_photos.photo	homepage_sections + media_assets	Lower risk — homepage is being rebuilt

5.3 The Query-String URL Problem — The Most Critical Technical Insight

The legacy site has NO slug, alias, path, uri, permalink, route, or canonical columns in any table. The entire legacy URL space is query-string driven. This is the single most technically important finding in the entire guide.

Proven legacy URL patterns (evidence: stored URL values in jx_categories, jx_docs, embedded HTML, jx_config1):

Pattern	Example	Confidence	Entities
Homepage/landing	index.php?lang=1 or index.php?mylang	HIGH	Root entry point
FAQ pages	index.php?page=faqs&ex=2&dir=faqs...	HIGH	1,553 FAQ rows
List views	index.php?page=list&ex=2&dir=items&service=N	HIGH	Multiple content groups
Honor/alumni lists	index.php?page=list&ex=2&dir=good_students/graduated_students&d=N	HIGH	6,316 student records
Staff profiles	/members/index.php?page=show&dir=councils&service=N&council_id=ID	HIGH	648+397 profiles — 153 embedded URL instances found
Faculty content	/[subsite]/index.php?page=show&dir=items&cat_id=ID&ser=N&lang=N	MEDIUM-HIGH	Subsite-specific content under /med/,

			/dent/, etc.
Static pages	index.php?dir=html&ex=1&page=contactus&lang=N	HIGH	21 static pages

Implication: the redirect resolver cannot match clean path segments. It must parse and normalize query-string parameters — page=, dir=, service=, cat_id=, council_id=, lang=, ex=, act=, ser= — and the parameter sort order must be normalized before hashing, or index.php?cat_id=5&lang=1 and index.php?lang=1&cat_id=5 will be treated as different URLs.

5.4 Legacy Data Quality Issues That Affect Import

Issue	Exact Evidence	Import Impact
Orphan records in jx_items	2 rows reference missing jx_categories parent IDs	Import must handle null/orphan parent gracefully — do not fail the batch
Orphan records in jx_categories	21 rows reference missing parent IDs	21 category nodes will be parentless — need explicit archive classification
Orphan records in jx_member_items	3 rows reference missing member_category_id	Small number but must be caught — these are research file attachments
Orphan records in jx_member_categories	31 rows reference missing parent IDs	31 research nodes without parent context — require manual review
jx_config vs jx_config1 — 22 key conflicts	180 shared keys, 22 with different values between the two config tables	Settings import must choose a winner per key. Wrong choices can affect subsite prefixes and domain behavior.
jx_councils vs jx_councils1 — structural divergence	243 ID overlap only — major differences in visibility, names, photos, CVs, rank values	These cannot be merged with a simple UNION. A reconciliation report per overlapping ID is required first.
Language IDs in seeder do not match legacy DB	Old IDs: 1=ar, 2=en, 3=fr, 6=sp, 7=ge. Seeder assumptions misaligned.	Any imported content could receive wrong locale assignment. Arabic and English content could be silently swapped.

6. New Schema Design Findings

These findings are derived exclusively from the real database/migrations schema. They were not possible to surface in any earlier analysis. They represent the deepest level of this audit.

6.1 Dual Content Storage — Undefined Source of Truth

pages.content_json AND six structured payload columns in page_translations (hero_payload, overview_cards_payload, stats_payload, body_payload, cta_payload, sidebar_payload) AND body (longtext) all exist simultaneously. No rule defines which field is the source of truth for a given page type.

The likely intent based on schema design:

- content_json on pages — block editor output (versioned by builder_schema_version)
- hero_payload, overview_cards_payload etc. in page_translations — structured section data for specific template types, locale-separated
- body longtext in page_translations — legacy WYSIWYG or simple rich text fallback

The risk: if PageService does not have an explicit documented rule for which field wins per template type, the following bugs become likely:

- An editor updates content_json but a template reads hero_payload — content appears unchanged
- SeoMetadataService reads excerpt from the wrong field — meta descriptions pulled from stale data
- A future developer adds content to both fields — one overwrites the other on next save

Required action: document a precedence matrix in PageService comments or a dedicated ADR (Architecture Decision Record) before service implementation begins.

6.2 pages.slug Has No Locale Awareness

The pages table has a single slug column (unique globally). page_translations has no slug column. The guide's recommended URL structure is /ar/{slug} and /en/{slug}. The schema does not enforce or define how these relate.

Design Interpretation	Implications	Risk
One page row, one slug, locale from URL prefix	Routes /ar/{slug} and /en/{slug} resolve the same page row. Service reads locale from route, not from page.	Clean if enforced consistently. Fails if any code ever accesses page by slug without locale context — silent wrong-locale rendering.
Separate page row per locale with parent_id linking them	AR page and EN page are sibling rows linked via parent_id. Each has its own slug.	parent_id is a self-referential FK — the hreflang relationship must be inferred from this tree. A page could accidentally reference itself as its own alternate if parent_id is set incorrectly.

Neither interpretation is documented in any guide file. The service implementation must make an explicit choice and enforce it. The guide's hreflang requirements — that each locale page references the other — depend entirely on this architectural decision being made and documented.

6.3 Redundant Columns on users Table

Column Pair	Problem	Risk	Severity
role_slug (string, indexed) + role_id FK → roles.id	Two representations of the same role relationship. role_slug is a denormalized copy. If roles.slug ever changes, users.role_slug becomes stale without a migration.	Authorization bugs if code uses role_slug for permission checks but role_id has been updated and slug has not.	MEDIUM
failed_login_attempts + failed_attempts	Two columns tracking what appears to be the same concept. Undocumented distinction — possibly web login vs API auth.	If lockout logic reads one column but writes to the other, account lockout is unreliable. Security risk.	MEDIUM

6.4 media_assets Has Inconsistent Format Variant Strategy

Three different patterns coexist for storing file format variants:

- path — the primary file path (single canonical)
- webp_path — a hardcoded special case column for one format only
- srcset_json — a flexible JSON blob for other variants

If AVIF support is added later, it either gets another hardcoded column (avif_path) or goes into srcset_json — inconsistent. The proper long-term design is a separate variants table:

```
media_asset_variants(id, media_asset_id FK, format, width, height, path, size_bytes)
```

For current scope this is acceptable, but the SeoMetadataService and image rendering must not expose webp_path directly to templates. Abstract behind a media helper method so the path strategy can evolve without template changes.

6.5 page_seo_meta Has Dual OG Image Strategy With No Precedence Rule

page_seo_meta contains both og_image_media_id (nullable FK → media_assets) and og_image_url (plain string). No DB constraint prevents both being set simultaneously. The SeoMetadataService must implement and document an explicit precedence rule:

```
og_image = og_image_media_id ? mediaAsset.url : og_image_url
```

Without this rule, different code paths will produce different OG images for the same page — inconsistent social share previews across implementations.

6.6 hreflang_payload is a JSON Blob With No Validation

page_seo_meta.hreflang_payload stores hreflang data as unvalidated JSON. The guide's requirements are strict: absolute URLs, reciprocal references, locale-matched canonicals. The schema provides no enforcement of any of these.

Validation Gap	Guide Requirement	Schema Enforcement	Severity
URL absoluteness	hreflang must use fully-qualified absolute URLs	None — a relative URL like /ar/about passes with no error	HIGH

Reciprocal references	If page A lists page B as alternate, page B must list page A	None — orphaned one-way references are silently valid	HIGH
Locale matching	Arabic canonical must not point to English page	None — any URL can be set for any locale	MEDIUM

Required action: SeoMetadataService must validate hreflang_payload on write. If page A lists page B as an alternate, the service must verify that page B's hreflang_payload contains a reciprocal reference back to page A. Fail or warn if not. This cannot be deferred to QA.

6.7 research_publications.category_key and menu_items.group_key Are Unvalidated Strings

Both use the same anti-pattern — a plain string key instead of a FK to a category/menu definition table. Consequences:

- A typo in category_key creates a phantom category with no validation error and no admin feedback
- Research category names cannot be translated — no research_category_translations table
- If the STRUCTURED_DATA_AND_METADATA_MATRIX.md recommendations for Course or ResearchProject schema are implemented, these category_key values must be human-readable translated strings — which requires normalization

6.8 faculty_member_translations.specializations Must Render Server-Side

specializations is stored as a JSON array. The guide recommends ProfilePage structured data for faculty pages, which can include knowsAbout. If specializations are rendered client-side only (JavaScript-injected), they are invisible to crawlers. The service layer must ensure specializations render in server-side HTML for both the visible page and the structured data output.

7. Critical Findings — Ranked by Launch Risk

Each finding is numbered, severity-rated, and tied to specific evidence. Cross-references are provided for every claim.

FINDING 01 — Zero Production-Ready Public Pages

Attribute	Detail
Severity	CRITICAL
Evidence	NEW_SYSTEM_FINDINGS.md: 'GET / → default Laravel welcome view. No other public routes are currently proven by the codebase.'
Cross-ref	README.md, START_HERE.md, MANDATORY_CODE §1 all confirm this as a launch blocker
Impact	Any public cutover today results in all 4,944 legacy categories, 22,323 items, 648 faculty profiles, and all other content returning 404. Users and crawlers see only the Laravel default page.
Required action	Implement IMPLEMENTATION_BLUEPRINT Phase 1: homepage rendering, current-scope landing pages, AR/EN route resolution, navigation shell.

FINDING 02 — All 13 Service Contracts Are Placeholders That Throw Exceptions

Attribute	Detail
Severity	CRITICAL
Evidence	NEW_SYSTEM_FINDINGS.md: 'AppServiceProvider binds 13 service interfaces to 13 placeholder services under app/Services/Placeholders/ — these throw BadMethodCallException instead of implementing functionality.'
Schema status	The schema is now mostly ready for these services — pages, page_translations, page_seo_meta, homepage_sections, menu_items, settings, media_assets all exist. The blocker is no longer schema. It is code.
Affected services	PageService, SeoMetadataService, NavigationService, PreviewService, HomepagePublishingService — and 8 others
Required action	Replace placeholders in priority order: PageService → HomepagePublishingService → NavigationService → SeoMetadataService → PreviewService. Schema is ready to receive these implementations now.

FINDING 03 — No Redirect Layer Exists for 36,000+ Legacy Content Addresses

Attribute	Detail
Severity	CRITICAL
Evidence	NEW_SYSTEM_FINDINGS.md: 'No redirect tables, middleware, resolver, or catch-all legacy routing layer is currently implemented.' Real schema: zero of five required redirect tables exist.

Scale	4,944 category URLs + 22,323 item URLs + 648+397 profile URLs + 5,246 alumni + 1,070 honor students + 1,553 FAQs — all query-string-addressed, all without redirect destinations.
Critical complication	OLD_SYSTEM_FINDINGS.md proves the legacy URL space is entirely query-string driven (index.php?page=show&dir=councils&council_id=X). Simple path-based redirects are insufficient. A query-aware resolver with parameter normalization is required.
Required action	Create the five missing tables (legacy_exact_redirects, legacy_url_map, legacy_pattern_rules, unresolved_legacy_requests, legacy_file_inventory). Then implement LegacyRedirectService following SEARCH_CONTINUITY_BLUEPRINT.md's layered resolution model.

FINDING 04 — public/storage Is Not Linked

Attribute	Detail
Severity	CRITICAL
Evidence	NEW_SYSTEM_FINDINGS.md: 'php artisan about reports public/storage is not linked.'
Impact	All file and media delivery fails. This includes PDFs (6,000 legacy documents), faculty CVs, research files, and images. The guide dedicates an entire file to file preservation (FILE_PDF_AND_ARCHIVE_PRESERVATION.md) yet the storage symlink does not exist.
Fix effort	Trivial: php artisan storage:link. However its absence indicates file delivery has never been tested end-to-end.
Required action	php artisan storage:link immediately. Then test file delivery with representative file types including PDF, DOCX, and image before considering public launch.

FINDING 05 — /admin Path Conflict Is an Undecided Launch Blocker

Attribute	Detail
Severity	CRITICAL
Evidence	OLD_SYSTEM_FINDINGS.md: jx_config1 proves spu.edu.sy/admin was a public legacy section. IMPLEMENTATION_BLUEPRINT Phase 4 flags this as a required decision. RISK_REGISTER_AND_DECISION_LOG.md lists it as a mandatory decision — and contains zero decisions.
Impact	If the new Filament CMS is deployed at /admin (its default), it overwrites a historically public path. Any backlinks to /admin-section content return a login redirect. Any user navigating there hits authentication instead of institutional content.
Required action	Make and document the decision: either move the CMS to /cms or another non-conflicting path, or implement a legacy /admin resolver that serves old content before new admin routes. This decision gates all deployment planning.

FINDING 06 — QUICK_REFERENCE.md Lists Two Artisan Commands That Do Not Exist

Attribute	Detail
Severity	HIGH
Evidence	QUICK_REFERENCE.md lists migration:inspect-legacy-url and migration:audit-redirect-map as launch-day helpers. NEW_SYSTEM_FINDINGS.md confirms the codebase has no Artisan commands beyond Laravel defaults — only ExampleTest.php exists in tests/.
Impact	A developer following the Quick Reference on launch day runs commands that fail immediately. In a high-pressure launch window, false tooling documentation costs time and trust.
Required action	Either implement these commands (they would be genuinely valuable) or remove them from QUICK_REFERENCE.md with a note that they are planned. The document must not assert the existence of tools that do not exist.

FINDING 07 — The Seeder Cannot Import Legacy Data Correctly

Attribute	Detail
Severity	HIGH
Evidence	NEW_SYSTEM_FINDINGS.md: 'many branches log Schema analysis needed; the admin migration writes to fields/tables not created by current migrations; language mapping assumptions do not match the old DB language IDs cleanly.'
Specific mismatch	OLD_SYSTEM_FINDINGS.md documents legacy language IDs: 1=ar, 2=en, 3=fr, 6=sp, 7=ge. The seeder's ID assumptions are misaligned with these values.
Impact	Any data migration attempt will either fail silently, import content with wrong language assignments, or crash with FK errors. Arabic and English content could be assigned to each other's locale.
Secondary issue	config/old_database.php maps legacy tables to target names (content_items, categories, archived_content) that do not exist in the real schema. The importer config must be fully rewritten before any migration run.
Required action	Fix language ID mapping. Rewrite config/old_database.php to target actual schema table names. Add migration tests that verify language assignment on imported records.

FINDING 08 — Zero Automated Tests for Migration-Critical Behavior

Attribute	Detail
Severity	HIGH
Evidence	NEW_SYSTEM_FINDINGS.md: 'tests/Feature/ExampleTest.php only checks that / returns 200. No migration, redirect, URL-resolution, sitemap, multilingual, or file-preservation tests exist yet.'

Required coverage (per MANDATORY_CODE §12)	Representative redirect tests, canonical output tests, hreflang output tests, sitemap generation tests, public file access tests, legacy query-string resolution tests, draft protection tests
Impact	Any implemented feature can regress silently between deployments. A redirect that works in development can break in production and go undetected until Search Console reports a crawl error spike.
Required action	Tests must be written in parallel with each service implementation — not after. Start with redirect behavior and canonical output, as these have the highest silent-failure risk.

FINDING 09 — The Risk Register Has No Actual Decisions

Attribute	Detail
Severity	HIGH
Evidence	RISK_REGISTER_AND_DECISION_LOG.md contains only a template with placeholder example text. Eight decisions are explicitly listed as mandatory before launch.
Mandatory undecided items	Cutover date approval, admin path strategy, archive preservation strategy, file preservation strategy, domain and hostname strategy, sitemap strategy, multilingual canonical strategy, rollback trigger threshold
Impact	Under launch pressure, undocumented decisions become team disagreements at the worst possible moment. The guide itself identifies this risk: 'Most migration damage happens because teams never wrote down the decisions clearly enough to act fast under pressure.'
Required action	Fill the decision log before any Phase 2 implementation begins. Undecided questions block architecture choices downstream.

FINDING 10 — hreflang Reciprocity Cannot Be Enforced by the Schema

Attribute	Detail
Severity	HIGH
Evidence	Real schema: page_seo_meta.hreflang_payload is a JSON column with no validation. Guide requirement (MANDATORY_CODE §4): 'output only valid alternates; ensure reciprocal alternates.'
Specific risk	If the Arabic version of a page is created with an EN alternate link, but the English page is then republished without a reciprocal AR link, the hreflang pair becomes one-directional. Google treats non-reciprocal hreflang as invalid and ignores it. This failure is invisible without an explicit validation step.
Required action	SeoMetadataService must validate reciprocity on every hreflang write. When page A sets page B as an alternate, verify page B's hreflang_payload contains A as a reciprocal. Fail with an exception or emit a logged warning.

FINDING 11 — French, Spanish, and German Legacy Content Has No Migration Plan

Attribute	Detail
Severity	MEDIUM
Evidence	OLD_SYSTEM_FINDINGS.md documents jx_languages with IDs 3=fr, 6=sp, 7=ge. No file in the guide addresses what happens to content in these languages.
Impact	If any legacy content in French, Spanish, or German is indexed or backlinked, it will 404 post-migration with no redirect or archive destination. The guide provides no classification for these language IDs.
Required action	Add a decision to RISK_REGISTER_AND_DECISION_LOG.md explicitly classifying non-AR/EN legacy content. Options: (a) archive with legacy-locale preservation, (b) map to closest AR/EN equivalent, (c) intentionally retire with 410. The decision must be documented — not defaulted to accidental 404.

FINDING 12 — Dual Content Storage Has No Documented Precedence Rule

Attribute	Detail
Severity	MEDIUM
Evidence	Real schema: pages.content_json (JSON on the pages table) + page_translations.hero_payload, overview_cards_payload, stats_payload, body_payload, cta_payload, sidebar_payload (six locale-specific JSON columns) + page_translations.body (longtext). No document specifies which field is canonical for which page type.
Impact	Double-write bugs, inconsistent rendering, and SEO metadata pulled from wrong fields are all predictable consequences. The guide's requirement for correct meta_title, meta_description, and canonical output depends on reading from the right field.
Required action	Document a precedence matrix before PageService implementation: which template types use content_json, which use the structured payload columns, which use body. This decision cannot be made retroactively after services are written.

8. SEO Architecture Evaluation

Evaluated against `AUTHORITATIVE_REFERENCES.md`, `SEO_PRESERVATION_GUIDE.md`, `STRUCTURED_DATA_AND_METADATA_MATRIX.md`, `SEARCH_CONTINUITY_BLUEPRINT.md`, and the real schema.

8.1 Redirect Architecture — Design Quality

The layered resolution model in `SEARCH_CONTINUITY_BLUEPRINT.md` — exact lookup → pattern rules → DB-backed query-string fallback → unresolved logging — is production-grade. This is the correct professional architecture for a legacy PHP to Laravel migration.

One specification gap not in the guide: query-string parameter sort-order normalization. The URL `index.php?cat_id=5&lang=1` and `index.php?lang=1&cat_id=5` are the same page. Before hashing a legacy URL into a lookup key, parameters must be sorted alphabetically. Without this step, the resolver will miss identical URLs that differ only in parameter order.

8.2 hreflang Implementation

Requirement	Guide Coverage	Schema Support	Verdict
Reciprocal references	Explicitly required in <code>MANDATORY_CODE §4</code> and <code>SEO_PRESERVATION_GUIDE §7.3</code>	JSON blob — no enforcement	HIGH
Fully-qualified absolute URLs	Explicitly required in all hreflang sections	JSON blob — no enforcement	HIGH
Same-locale canonical rule	Explicitly required: Arabic → Arabic, English → English	Separate <code>page_seo_meta</code> per locale — enforced if service is correct	PASS
x-default handling	Correctly optional — only if a deliberate non-locale default exists	Supported via <code>hreflang_payload</code> JSON	PASS
Edge case: one locale unpublished	Listed as edge case in <code>MANDATORY_CODE §4</code>	<code>page_translations</code> unique on <code>page_id+locale</code> — handles missing locale cleanly	PASS
PDF hreflang via HTTP headers	Mentioned as inference — no implementation code given	<code>media_assets</code> has no hreflang metadata column	MEDIUM

8.3 Structured Data Scope

Schema Type	Guide Recommendation	Schema Backing	Assessment
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WebSite	Required on homepage for site name	pages + page_seo_meta → correct place for JSON-LD injection	Correct recommendation
Organization	Required on homepage for institutional identity	settings table can store org identity data	Correct and important for a university
BreadcrumbList	Required on section and detail pages	pages.parent_id enables hierarchy reconstruction	Correct — schema supports breadcrumb tree
ProfilePage	Recommended for faculty/staff/researcher pages	faculty_members + faculty_member_translations + research_publications	Strong fit — schema backs all required fields
Article/NewsArticle	Medium-high, only when truly article-like	pages + page_translations support article-like content	Correctly scoped
FAQPage	Low-medium — current Google restrictions noted	faqs + faq_translations — schema is ready	Correctly scoped with appropriate warning
Event	Not mentioned in guide	No events table in schema	Gap — universities have public events (open days, lectures). Consider adding.
Course	Not mentioned in guide	No courses table in schema	Gap — Google supports Course schema. Relevant for program pages.

8.4 Webometrics Strategy

The guide's Webometrics analysis is accurate. 50/10/40 for Visibility/Transparency/Excellence is correct per the verified methodology. The 'Presence' discontinuation is correctly flagged. The practical recommendations — one strong domain, faculty discoverability, open academic files, English strategic content — correctly map to the current methodology.

8.5 The robots.txt Gap

The guide mentions robots.txt in 6+ files as a launch gate item. No file specifies what it should contain for SPU's URL structure. A robots.txt that accidentally disallows /ar/ or /en/ would block the entire bilingual public surface from crawling. A template must be added to MANDATORY_CODE §5 or a dedicated section specifying at minimum: allow /ar/, allow /en/, disallow /cms/ (or whatever admin path is chosen), disallow /preview/.

9. Launch Readiness Scorecard

Using the exact go/no-go gates from QA_AND_LAUNCH_SAFETY.md, evaluated against evidence from NEW_SYSTEM_FINDINGS.md, the real schema, and the guide files.

QA Gate (from QA_AND_LAUNCH_SAFETY.md)	Status	Basis
Top legacy landing pages mapped and tested	CRITICAL	No redirect tables exist. No LegacyRedirectService. 0% complete.
Top linked PDFs and files mapped and tested	CRITICAL	public/storage not linked. legacy_file_inventory table absent. media_assets schema is ready but file mapping is not done.
Site resolves legacy query-string URLs safely	CRITICAL	No resolver. No legacy_url_map table. No pattern rules. 0% complete.
Sitemap generation live	CRITICAL	No SitemapService, no sitemap routes. Schema ready (pages etc.) but zero implementation.
Canonical tags live on public pages	CRITICAL	page_seo_meta.canonical_url column exists — schema ready. But there are no public pages and SeoMetadataService is a placeholder.
AR and EN hreflang correct on representative pairs	CRITICAL	hreflang_payload column exists — schema ready. No public pages, no service implementation, no reciprocal validation.
Staging is non-indexable	INFO	Cannot assess from provided materials. Must be verified separately.
Unresolved-request logging live	CRITICAL	unresolved_legacy_requests table does not exist. No logging service.
Search Console and Bing Webmaster Tools ready	INFO	Cannot assess from provided materials. Must be verified separately.
/admin path conflict resolved	CRITICAL	Decision not made. RISK_REGISTER_AND_DECISION_LOG.md is empty. No decision is documented.

Result: 8 of 10 QA gates are critical failures. 2 cannot be assessed. Current launch readiness: effectively 0%.

Revised assessment incorporating schema progress:

- Schema layer: ~75% complete — CMS core tables exist, domain tables exist, migration audit tables exist
- Application layer: ~5% complete — 13 placeholders, 1 public route, 0 public templates
- Redirect/continuity layer: 0% complete — no tables, no service, no tooling
- SEO output layer: 0% complete — no canonical output, no hreflang, no sitemap
- Testing layer: 0% complete — no migration-relevant tests

10. Prioritized Action Plan

Derived from the guide's IMPLEMENTATION_BLUEPRINT.md phasing, corrected for the real schema state, and enhanced with findings from this audit.

Phase 0 — Immediate (No Code Required, This Week)

Action	Why	Effort
Run: php artisan storage:link	public/storage not linked — file delivery is broken	5 min
Fill RISK_REGISTER_AND_DECISION_LOG.md — all 8 mandatory decisions	Undecided questions block all architecture and deployment decisions downstream	1 day
Decide and document /admin path strategy	Gates all deployment planning. Move CMS to /cms or document legacy /admin resolver requirement.	Half day
Remove or flag non-existent Artisan commands in QUICK_REFERENCE.md	False documentation erodes team trust during high-pressure launch moments	1 hour
Rewrite config/old_database.php to target actual schema table names	Current config targets non-existent tables — any seeder run will fail	Half day
Document content_json vs payload column precedence by page type	Must be decided before PageService implementation begins	Half day
Add decision for French/Spanish/German legacy content handling	All non-AR/EN content needs a documented fate — archive, redirect, or retire	2 hours

Phase 1 — Service Implementation (Weeks 1–3, Schema Now Ready)

The schema is substantially in place. Implementation can begin without waiting for additional migrations.

1. Replace PageServiceInterface placeholder — getPublishedPageBySlug(slug, locale) → PageDTO
2. Replace HomepagePublishingServiceInterface — getPublishedSections(locale) → SectionDTO[]
3. Replace NavigationServiceInterface — getMenuByGroupKey(key, locale) → MenuItemDTO tree
4. Replace SeoMetadataServiceInterface — resolveForPage(pageId, locale) → SeoDTO with canonical + hreflang + OG
5. Replace PreviewServiceInterface — createToken / resolveToken for draft preview access
6. Implement homepage and current-scope landing page routing in routes/web.php
7. Implement AR/EN locale resolution from URL prefix (/ar/, /en/)
8. Implement draft protection — published_at + status must gate all public routes
9. Write tests: AR page renders, EN page renders, draft does not leak, canonical is correct

Phase 2 — Redirect and Continuity Layer (Weeks 2–4, Highest Risk)

10. Create 5 missing redirect tables: legacy_exact_redirects, legacy_url_map, legacy_pattern_rules, unresolved_legacy_requests, legacy_file_inventory
11. Create LegacyRedirectServiceInterface contract and implementation

12. Implement exact redirect lookup with query-string parameter sort-order normalization
13. Implement pattern-based rules for 12 known public subpath families
14. Implement DB-backed fallback resolver for `index.php?page=show&dir=...&id=...` patterns
15. Implement unresolved request logging with deduplication (normalize before storing)
16. Build legacy file inventory from `jx_items.en_file` (6,000 rows) and related fields
17. Build legacy URL inventory export from old DB for redirect mapping workbook
18. Write tests: representative query-string redirects, file redirects, unresolved logging, homepage fallback is NOT used for valuable content

Phase 3 — SEO Output Layer (Weeks 3–5, Parallel Where Possible)

19. Implement canonical URL generation per page type and locale in `SeoMetadataService`
20. Implement hreflang generation with reciprocal validation — fail or warn if pair is broken
21. Implement sitemap index + child sitemaps (pages, profiles, research, alumni)
22. Create and publish robots.txt with explicit `/ar/`, `/en/` allow and `/cms/` (or admin path) disallow
23. Implement Organization + WebSite JSON-LD on homepage template
24. Implement BreadcrumbList JSON-LD using `pages.parent_id` tree on section/detail templates
25. Implement ProfilePage JSON-LD on faculty member pages — ensure specializations render server-side
26. Write tests: canonical output per template, hreflang pairs, sitemap URLs are canonical only, robots.txt

Phase 4 — Pre-Launch Verification (Week 6–7)

27. Run full `QA_AND_LAUNCH_SAFETY.md` checklist — all 10 go/no-go gates must pass
28. Build and run smoke-test URL pack: representative old query-string URLs → expected destinations
29. Verify `jx_councils` vs `jx_councils1` reconciliation for the 243 overlapping IDs
30. Fix language ID mapping in `CompleteDatabaseMigrationSeeder` — verify with spot-check import
31. Implement and test the two Artisan commands listed in `QUICK_REFERENCE.md` or remove them
32. Submit sitemap to Google Search Console and Bing Webmaster Tools
33. Verify staging is non-indexable
34. Complete `LAUNCH_COMMAND_CENTER_PLAYBOOK.md` role assignments
35. Conduct a controlled pre-launch using representative real traffic on staging

11. Final Verdict

✓ What the Guide Gets Right Every verifiable SEO rule is technically correct Webometrics figures are accurate and current hreflang rules fully match Google specification Redirect architecture is production-grade FAQ rich-result restriction correctly identified Query-string URL problem correctly diagnosed File/PDF preservation correctly scoped Honest about migration uncertainty — no false promises robots.txt / noindex rule stated correctly	✗ What the Guide Misses or Gets Wrong NEW_SYSTEM_FINDINGS.md is now stale — schema is more complete than claimed Two non-existent Artisan commands listed as ready Risk register contains zero actual decisions config/old_database.php maps to non-existent tables French/Spanish/German legacy content has no plan No robots.txt template or content specification No timeline or effort estimates for 6-phase plan hreflang reciprocity has no schema or service enforcement Dual content storage (content_json vs payloads) undefined
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Bottom Line: The documentation package is one of the better migration guides a student team could produce. Its SEO architecture is correct, its sources are verified, and its self-assessment is honest. The real project state is more advanced than the guide reflects — the schema has progressed significantly beyond what NEW_SYSTEM_FINDINGS.md describes. But the implementation is still 5–7 weeks from a responsible launch. The redirect continuity layer does not exist at all. All 13 services are placeholders. There are no public pages. The gap between the plan and the code is real — and it is precisely what the guide warned about from the first file.

Appendix A — File-by-File Assessment

File	Purpose	Quality	Key Finding
README.md	Package overview and entry point	PASS	Accurate. Correctly states project is foundation-stage. No errors.
START_HERE.md	First-read orientation	PASS	Correct priorities. Good guardrails. No errors.
AUTHORITATIVE_REFERENCES.md	Source citations with URLs	PASS	All sources are official and verified. Webometrics figures confirmed correct on 2026-04-21.
OLD_SYSTEM_FINDINGS.md	Legacy database evidence	PASS	Most valuable file. Accurate, evidence-based, specific row counts and field analysis.
NEW_SYSTEM_FINDINGS.md	New codebase evidence	HIGH	Accurate at time of writing — now STALE. Schema is significantly more complete. Must be updated.
SEO_PRESERVATION_GUIDE.md	Main migration strategy	PASS	Comprehensive and technically accurate. Best file in the package.
MANDATORY_CODE_IMPLEMENTATION_REQUIREMENTS.md	Developer build specification	PASS	Excellent scope and detail. Missing robots.txt template.
IMPLEMENTATION_BLUEPRINT.md	Engineering backlog	PASS	Correct phase ordering. Missing timeline and effort estimates.
SEARCH_CONTINUITY_BLUEPRINT.md	Redirect layer architecture	PASS	Production-grade design. Missing query parameter sort-order normalization note.

LEGACY_TO_NEW_MAPPING.md	Entity mapping guide	PASS	Good framework. Missing FR/SP/GE language handling and jx_councils reconciliation algorithm.
STRUCTURED_DATA_AND_METADATA_MATRIX.md	Schema type scope	PASS	Accurate. Missing Event and Course schema types relevant for a university.
FILE_PDF_AND_ARCHIVE_PRESERVATION.md	File migration rules	PASS	Correct priorities. PDF hreflang HTTP header section needs implementation guidance.
QA_AND_LAUNCH_SAFETY.md	Go/no-go gates	PASS	Well-defined gates. Currently 8 of 10 fail.
LAUNCH_COMMAND_CENTER_PLAYBOOK.md	Launch operations	PASS	Professional operations guide. Role slots not filled in.
RISK_REGISTER_AND_DECISION_LOG.md	Risk and decision tracking	HIGH	Template only — zero actual decisions recorded. Major operational gap.
QUICK_REFERENCE.md	Launch-day checklist	HIGH	Two non-existent Artisan commands listed. Creates false confidence on launch day.
STUDENT_EXECUTION_BRIEF.md	Student brief	PASS	Clear and correctly prioritised. Good professional framing.
STUDENT_CODING_PLAYBOOK.md	Developer coding guide	PASS	Practical and correct. Good migration-first mindset.
SQL_AND_TECHNICAL_APPENDIX.md	SQL reference queries	PASS	Queries are correct. Missing: a query to list the 22 jx_config/jx_config 1 conflict values.

HOW_THIS_PREVENTS_RANKING_DROPS.md	Stakeholder explainer	PASS	Accurate signal-protection framing. Good teaching document.
ULTIMATE_SEO_MIGRATION_GUIDE.md	One-file executive digest	PASS	Accurate and concise. Good for stakeholders.
VISUAL_ROADMAP.md	Phase diagram	MEDIUM	Mermaid code only — renders as raw text in non-Mermaid environments.
RANKING_PROTECTION_VISUAL_GUIDE.md	Signal protection diagram	MEDIUM	Same Mermaid rendering concern.
INDEX.md	Document routing by audience	PASS	Useful audience-routing. Minor overlap with README.md.

Appendix B — Schema Status Quick Reference

Table Group	Tables	Status	Notes
CMS Core	pages, page_translations, page_seo_meta, homepage_sections, homepage_section_translations, homepage_drafts, page_drafts, preview_tokens, menu_items, settings, media_assets	PASS	All present. No missing tables in this group.
Auth/Admin	users, roles, audit_logs, sessions, cache, jobs, failed_jobs, password_reset_tokens	PASS	Present. Two redundant columns on users (role_slug + role_id, and dual failed_attempts columns).
Faculty	faculties, faculty_translations, departments, department_translations, faculty_members, faculty_member_translations	PASS	Complete. Supports ProfilePage structured data.
Research	research_publications, research_publication_translations, research_files	PASS	Complete. research_files links to media_assets correctly.
Councils	councils, council_translations, council_members, council_member_translations	PASS	Present. Reconciliation of jx_councils vs jx_councils1 still required before import.
Students	alumni, alumni_translations, honor_students, honor_student_translations	PASS	Complete. Both have faculty_id and department_id FKs.
FAQ	faq_categories, faq_category_translations, faqs, faq_translations	PASS	Complete. Maps cleanly to jx_faqs (1,553 rows).
Complaints	complaint_categories, complaint_category_translations, complaints	PASS	Complete. Low migration priority.
Locations	countries, country_translations, cities, city_translations	PASS	Complete. Reference data for alumni/honor students.
Career	career_links, career_link_translations	PASS	New capability — not in legacy system.
Migration Audit	migration_logs, migration_rejections, legacy_record_snapshots	PASS	Professional-grade audit trail. legacy_record_snapshots is a snapshot store, NOT a redirect resolver.
Redirect Layer	legacy_exact_redirects, legacy_url_map, legacy_pattern_rules,	REMAINS	All five tables absent. This is the primary remaining launch blocker.

	unresolved_legacy_requests, legacy_file_inventory		
Menu Container	menus (top-level)	PARTIAL	menu_items uses group_key string — no parent menus table. Integrity risk.
Sitemap	sitemap_entries or similar	INFO	Not present. Sitemap can be generated dynamically — low priority.